

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.10: Relative Clauses of Characteristic and Related Uses

Distinguish factual, characteristic, purpose, causal, and concessive relatives through an evidence scale while parsing the relative form independently

Stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisite	EL-II.9 mastery: classify and transform conditional stance and time
Next	EL-II.11, Commands, Prohibitions, Wishes, and Fearing

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Relative clauses of characteristic and related uses

On completing this unit, you can:

- distinguish a factual relative clause from one characterizing a kind of person or thing;
- recognize characteristic after negative, indefinite, or class-defining antecedents;
- separate characteristic from relative purpose, cause, and concession;
- account for mood rather than translating every relative identically.

1.1 Fact or characteristic?

A **factual relative clause** asserts information about an antecedent treated as definite. A **relative clause of characteristic** describes the kind or class of person or thing represented by its antecedent rather than asserting a single identifying fact. The difference is one of viewpoint, not of the relative pronoun's form.

Indicative and subjunctive relatives

An indicative relative normally adds an asserted fact about a definite or treated-as-definite antecedent: *agnus qui tollit*, “the Lamb who takes away.” A subjunctive relative characterizes the sort of antecedent meant: *nemo est qui faciat*, “there is no one of the sort who does.” Common frames are *sunt qui* (there are some who), *nemo/nullus est qui*, *quis est qui?*, and a general class after *dignus*, *indignus*, *idoneus* or a superlative/restriction.

The rule is semantic, not automatic. *Quis est qui vincit?* may take indicative when the question asks the identity of an actual victor. Conversely, a definite-looking antecedent can take subjunctive if the writer presents it as a type.

Other subjunctive relatives

A relative clause can express purpose (“to do”), cause (“since he”), or concession (“although he”). Negative relative purpose uses *qui non*, not *ne* alone. Characteristic follows sequence of tenses when dependent on a governing past verb, but a timeless generalization may retain present subjunctive. Always give two labels: the relative word's case-role and the clause's semantic use.

1.2 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: negative antecedent (Psalm 13:3)

Worked passage ID: W.II.40; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Non est qui faciat bonum, non est usque ad unum.

Analysis. *Qui* is nominative singular and subject of present subjunctive *faciat*. After impersonal negative *non est*, the clause characterizes the nonexistent class of one who does good.

Translation. “There is no one who does good; there is not even one.”

Worked example: an actual identity (1 John 5:5)

Worked passage ID: W.II.41; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Quis est qui vincit mundum, nisi qui credit quoniam Iesus est Filius Dei?

Analysis. Both *vincit* and *credit* are indicative. The question is answered by an actual, asserted identity—the one who believes—rather than a merely possible class. *Qui* is nominative in each clause.

Translation. “Who is it that conquers the world, except the one who believes that Jesus is the Son of God?”

Worked example: factual relative and jussive (Matthew 11:15)

Worked passage ID: W.II.42; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Qui habet aures audiendi, audiat.

Analysis. Indicative *habet* asserts the condition of an open class: whoever in fact has ears for hearing. Subjunctive *audiat* is an independent jussive, not part of the relative clause. Genitive gerund *audiendi* depends on *aures*.

Translation. “He who has ears for hearing, let him hear.”

Worked example: relative ground in the Gloria

Worked passage ID: W.II.43; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Domine Fili unigenite, Iesu Christe; Domine Deus, Agnus Dei, Filius Patris; qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis.

Analysis. *Qui* is nominative masculine singular and refers to the addressee through the chain of vocative titles. Indicative *tollis* states the known ground of the plea; imperative *miserere* is the main request.

Translation. “Lord, only-begotten Son, Jesus Christ; Lord God, Lamb of God, Son of the Father; you who take away the sins of the world, have mercy on us.”

1.3 Writing laboratory

Copy *Non est qui faciat bonum* beside *Agnus qui tollit peccata mundi*. Mark the same morphology of *qui*, then explain in one sentence why the verb moods differ.

Compose a factual relative after *sacerdos*, a characteristic after *nemo est*, a relative purpose after *misit servum*, and an identity question after *quis est*. For the last, write one indicative and one subjunctive version and explain the different viewpoint.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Fact or characteristic? — transfer practice

Connection. An evidence scale makes the factual/characteristic decision cumulative rather than mechanical.

Transfer task. Pair lesson relatives that differ in mood or antecedent type. Score evidence from identified versus indefinite/class antecedent, mood, negation, governing expression, and discourse purpose; then state the narrowest defensible reading.

Retrieval check. Give two independent signals that support a characteristic reading.

1.2 Reading the forms in context — transfer practice

Connection. Relative purpose, cause, and concession answer different discourse questions even when subjunctive mood recurs.

Transfer task. For each related-use example in the lesson, write the question it answers—what end, what alleged reason, despite what circumstance—and cite the governor or context that supports the label.

Retrieval check. Explain why characteristic is not the default label for every subjunctive relative.

1.3 Writing laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. Minimal pairs reveal how mood and viewpoint change while relative morphology can remain stable.

Transfer task. Complete the lesson's indicative/subjunctive identity pair and the requested purpose and characteristic clauses. Label antecedent coordinates, internal case, mood, and discourse relation on each.

Retrieval check. State which relative-pronoun properties can stay unchanged when clause use changes.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Relative characteristic: parallel forms

Worksheet II.37 — Characteristic A

Worksheet ID: II.37

Focus: factual relatives, characteristic, identity, purpose

Use: Give both relative case and clause use.

1. Choose mood: *Agnus qui peccata mundi (tollere)* _____.

2. Choose mood: *Nemo est qui bonum (facere)* _____.

3. Parse *qui* in *sunt qui credant*.

4. Write relative purpose: "He sent a servant to call them."

5. Text: *Non est qui faciat bonum, non est usque ad unum.*

Passage ID: II.37.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Explain mood and translate.

6. Write an actual identity and a possible characteristic after *quis est qui*.

Worksheet II.40 — Characteristic D**Worksheet ID:** II.40**Focus:** factual relatives, characteristic, identity, purpose**Use:** Give both relative case and clause use.

1. Choose mood: *Verba quæ audivimus vera (esse)* _____.

2. Choose mood: *Quis est qui hæc intellegere (posse)* _____?

3. Parse *cui* in *nemo est cui dona tradamus*.

4. Change purpose clause *misit servum ut vocaret* to relative purpose.

5. **Text:** *Qui habet aures audiendi, audiat.*

Passage ID: II.40.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Separate relative and main clause; translate.

6. Write one pair showing a definite person and a characterized class.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Choose and defend mood in at least nine of ten contrasting relatives, parse every relative word's case correctly, and compose four clause types whose English renderings preserve their intended differences.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-II.11, Commands, Prohibitions, Wishes, and Fearing.

If it is not met: Worksheets II.38 and II.39 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Fact or characteristic? — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A negative, indefinite, or class-defining antecedent and subjunctive mood commonly converge on characteristic; discourse that describes a kind rather than reports an individual fact strengthens it. No one signal excuses parsing the relative pronoun and verb.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each use requires its own relation and evidence. Characteristic defines a class or kind; purpose expresses intended end; cause supplies or attributes reason; concession presents an obstacle that does not prevent the main assertion.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. With the same antecedent and internal function, gender, number, and case can remain unchanged; mood and discourse relation change. Each composed clause must preserve the intended use and a faithful English distinction.

CHAPTER 2

Relative characteristic: parallel forms

Solution II.37 — Characteristic A

Worksheet ID: II.37

Focus: factual relatives, characteristic, identity, purpose**Use:** Give both relative case and clause use.

1. Choose mood: *Agnus qui peccata mundi (tollere)* _____.
Answer / model: *tollit*, indicative: the title asserts a known fact about the definite Lamb.
2. Choose mood: *Nemo est qui bonum (facere)* _____.
Answer / model: *faciat*, present subjunctive characteristic after negative indefinite antecedent.
3. Parse *qui* in *sunt qui credant*.
Answer / model: Nominative masculine plural, subject of present subjunctive *credant*; characteristic: “there are some who believe.”
4. Write relative purpose: “He sent a servant to call them.”
Answer / model: *Misit servum qui eos vocaret*. *Qui* is nominative subject; imperfect follows historic *misit*.
5. **Text:** *Non est qui faciat bonum, non est usque ad unum*.
Passage ID: II.37.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Explain mood and translate.
Answer / notes: *Faciat* is present subjunctive characteristic after *non est*. “There is no one who does good; there is not even one.”
6. Write an actual identity and a possible characteristic after *quis est qui*.
Answer / model: *Quis est qui vincit?* asks who actually wins; *quis est qui hoc faciat?* can mean “who is there of the sort to do this?”

Solution II.40 — Characteristic D**Worksheet ID:** II.40**Focus:** factual relatives, characteristic, identity, purpose**Use:** Give both relative case and clause use.

1. Choose mood: *Verba quæ audivimus vera (esse) _____*.
Answer / model: *sunt*; factual relative *quæ audivimus* and asserted main predicate *vera sunt*.
2. Choose mood: *Quis est qui hæc intellegere (posse) _____?*
Answer / model: *possit* when rhetorical “who is there capable of understanding these things?” characterizes a class.
3. Parse *cui* in *nemo est cui dona tradamus*.
Answer / model: Dative singular relative, indirect object of *tradamus*; characteristic after *nemo est*.
4. Change purpose clause *misit servum ut vocaret* to relative purpose.
Answer / model: *Misit servum qui vocaret*.
5. **Text:** *Qui habet aures audiendi, audiat*.
Passage ID: II.40.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Separate relative and main clause; translate.
Answer / notes: Relative *qui habet aures audiendi* has indicative; main *audiat* is jussive. “He who has ears for hearing, let him hear.”
6. Write one pair showing a definite person and a characterized class.
Answer / model: Model: *Video sacerdotem qui offert; quæro sacerdotem qui offerat*. The first sees a definite factual priest; the second seeks one of the required kind.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.10, *Relative Clauses of Characteristic and Related Uses*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet uses an evidence scale rather than claiming that every subjunctive relative has one English formula.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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